

Audience Adaptation

Directions: You have been asked to present about what it is like to attend college at Baylor at several events, each of which have different audiences. Imagine you are preparing your informative speech for **two** of the following audience. In both, you will discuss the value and experience of a Baylor education. Choose any **two** of the following audiences and **compare/contrast** what information you would highlight about Baylor to adjust your message for each:

- High School seniors who have already decided to go to Baylor.
- High School seniors who are undecided in their college choice.
- High School freshmen whose parents did not/could not go to college, in effort to inspire them to go to college.
- Parents of Prospective Baylor Students.
- Potential Baylor Donors.

Answer each following questions to explore who your audiences are and how best to target their specific interests.

1. At first glance, what is most similar and most different about the audiences you chose?
Both these audiences are similar in the sense that they're both looking for information about the university which aligns with what they are looking for. They differ most in what it is that they both want; the donors want to hear they are supporting a "mission" which they support, and the seniors want to ensure that there tuition will serve them well (immediately, and in the future).
2. How much does each know about Baylor? Familiar? Unfamiliar?
High school seniors who are unsure of their choice have often not done a lot of research and are likely to know nothing about Baylor. The donor audience, however, will probably have done some research beforehand on the basics of the university.
3. What do they want to know? Why are they there? What information do they want and what would they care most about?
My answer here happens to be the exact same as my answer to question #1.
4. Which frame of reference characteristics matter? Age, cultural background, goals, experiences, economic status?
**Undecided Seniors: Youth, peer influence, and immediate career goals. Their economic status is usually "dependent" (relying on parents or loans).
Potential Donors: Career success, philanthropy, and legacy. Their economic status is "high net worth" or "established."**
5. Who are the key audience members? Who has the decision-making power? Who do you need to impress or motivate most?
For the undecided seniors, the key audience members is the students, but its equally important to impress both students and parents. For the donors, the key audience members are individual donors themselves (or the boards they represent) and this is who needs to be impressed.
6. How does your audience feel about you? The topic?

7. What information might each particular audience **not** care much about that the other audience may care greatly about?
8. Summarize what is significant or unique about your audiences and how you will strive to customize your message for them.
9. Write the three main points about Baylor you would share with each audience in your presentation below.